TEXORA · SESSIONAL NOTES · STUDY SHEET

Components of a Basic Shirt and Standard Body Measurement

Taking a basic shirt apart on paper: naming and drawing every component, and taking the standard body measurements — at their defined anatomical points — from which the shirt's patterns and specification are built.

TE-2208 · APPAREL MANUFACTURING TECHNOLOGY-1 SESSIONAL · STUDY 2 · LEVEL 2 TERM 2

1. Aim and place of the study

Aim: to list and draw the components of a basic shirt, and to practise standard body measurement for a shirt — the points, the method, and the recording of values in a measurement chart. The theory behind the specification sheet and sizing systems is in TE-2207 Topic 2; this study turns it into bench skill: the student who cannot name a component cannot cut it, and the student who measures carelessly drafts wrongly.

2. Components of a basic shirt

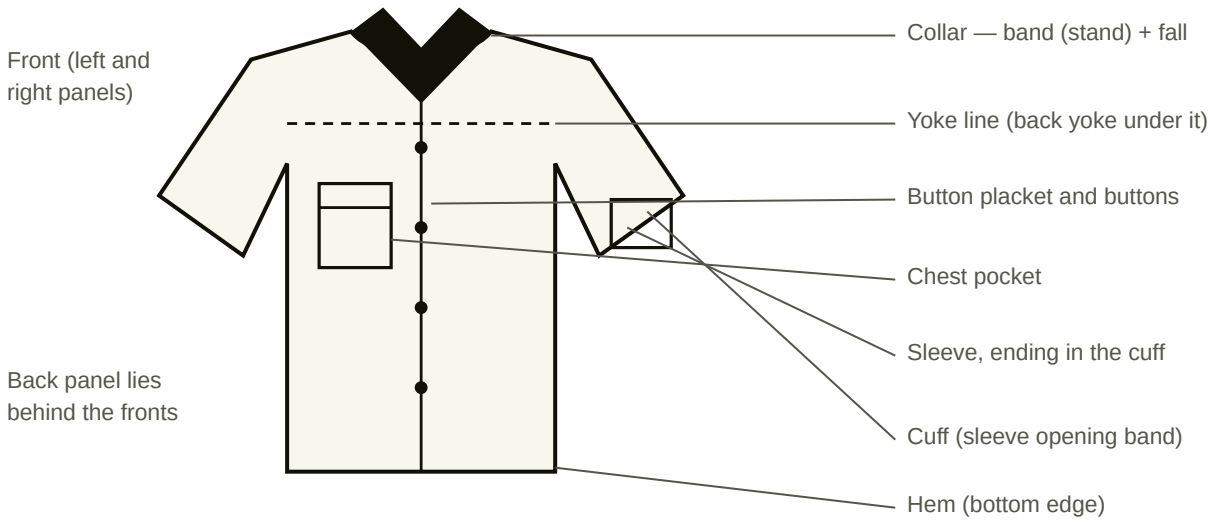


Figure 1 — Front view of a basic shirt with its components labelled. The back (one panel, usually with pleats or darts) and the sleeve placket are studied on the garment itself during the exercise.

COMPONENT	PIECES CUT	FUNCTION AND NOTES FOR THE STUDY
Front	2 (pair)	Left and right panels carrying the button placket (buttons) and buttonhole side; either may carry the chest pocket — record which side on your sketch.
Back	1	One panel across the full width, often with two pleats or darts below the yoke for shoulder-blade ease.
Yoke	1 (often doubled)	The horizontal panel across the shoulders that joins front and back and carries the shoulder seams.
Collar	Band + fall	Band (stand) rises from the neckline; the fall folds down over it. Both are usually interlined to hold shape.
Sleeve	2 (pair)	Set-in sleeves; a short slit (sleeve placket) at the cuff end lets the hand pass.
Cuff	2 (pair)	The band closing the sleeve opening, with button and buttonhole; interlined like the collar.
Placket	Part of front	The reinforced centre-front strip carrying buttons and buttonholes; may be a separate folded piece or grown-on.
Pocket	1 (usual)	Patch pocket on the left chest in most men's shirts, positioned by measurement from shoulder and centre front.
Interlining	As specified	Hidden component inside collar, band, cuff and placket fronts; gives body and crispness.

3. Standard body measurement — rules of the exercise

- The subject stands erect and relaxed, in light clothing, feet together, arms hanging naturally.
- The tape passes around the body horizontally for girths, sits snug against the body, and is never pulled tight — a tape that dents the skin is measuring the tape's tension, not the body.
- Every measurement is taken at a defined anatomical point, read to the nearest 0.5 cm, and recorded immediately in the chart — never trusted to memory.
- Key points are found by touch: the neck point (base of neck at the side), the shoulder point (the bony end of the shoulder), the fullest part of the chest, the natural waist line.

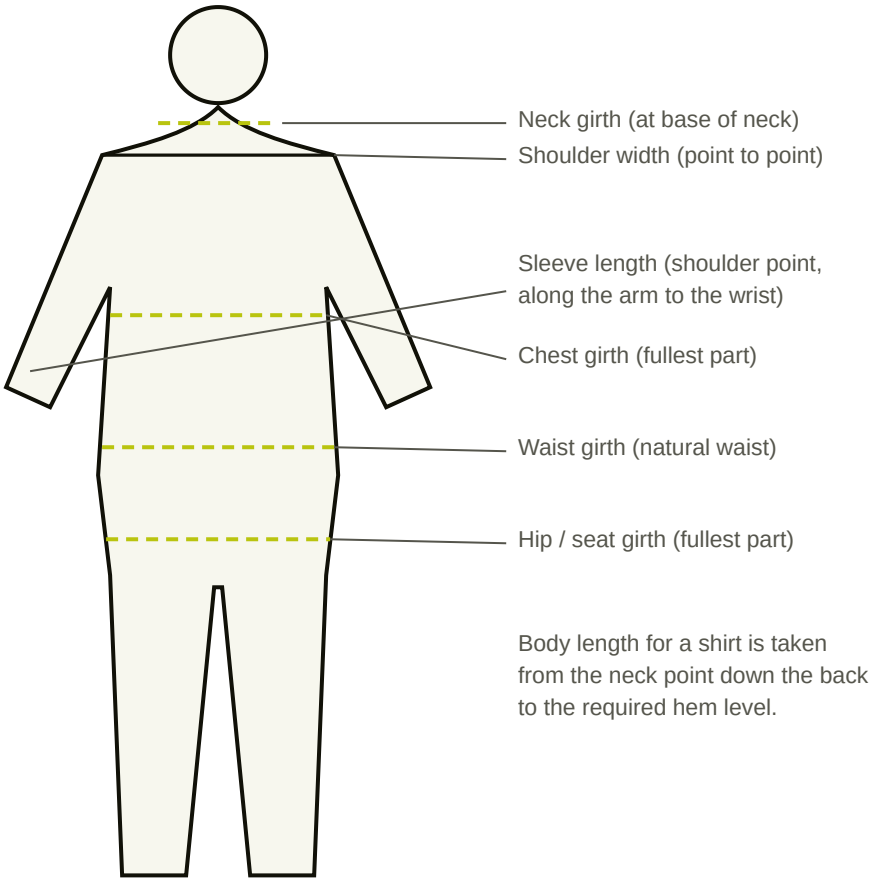


Figure 2 — The standard body measurement points used for a shirt: girths shown by the green dashed lines, lengths taken between the marked anatomical points.

4. The measurement points for a shirt

MEASUREMENT	EXACTLY HOW IT IS TAKEN	EXAMPLE CHART (CM)
Neck girth	Tape around the base of the neck, over the neck points, with one finger's ease inside the tape.	S 37 · M 39 · L 41 · XL 43
Chest girth	Tape around the fullest part of the chest, under the arms, horizontal, at normal breathing.	S 92 · M 97 · L 102 · XL 107
Waist girth	Tape around the natural waist line, the narrowest point above the hip bones.	S 76 · M 81 · L 86 · XL 92
Shoulder width	Across the back from shoulder point to shoulder point.	S 43 · M 45 · L 47 · XL 49
Sleeve (arm) length	From the shoulder point down the slightly bent arm to the wrist bone.	S 60 · M 61.5 · L 63 · XL 64.5

Back length	From the neck point down the centre back to the waist (and continued to hem level for total shirt length).	S 42 · M 43 · L 44 · XL 45

These are **body** measurements. Compare them with the garment specification studied in TE-2207 Topic 2: the size-M body chest of 97 cm becomes a garment chest of 107 cm — the 10 cm difference is ease. The collar of the finished shirt is sized from the neck girth with about 1 cm of wearing room: body neck 39 cm corresponds to the size-40 collar. Body charts are the input; garment specifications are the output; ease is the difference, and it belongs to the design, not to the measurer's discretion.

5. Procedure of the study

1. Sketch the shirt front (and back, on the return) and label every component; check your labels against the table in §2 by pointing to each part on a real garment.
2. In pairs, take the six measurements of §4 on your partner, recording each value at once, then repeat the set — the two sets should agree within 0.5 cm at every point.
3. Enter the agreed values in a chart in the format of §4, and identify the nearest standard size from the chart columns.
4. From your partner's size, read the corresponding garment specification values from TE-2207 Topic 2 §1.1, and write the ease at chest and collar beside them.

6. Precautions

- Never measure over heavy clothing; a jacket adds its own thickness to every girth.
- Keep the tape horizontal for girths — a sloping tape always over-reads.
- Measure both shoulder points by touch, not by eye; asymmetry recorded now is information, not error.
- Record in ink, in centimetres, at the moment of measuring; a value "remembered" across the room is a value invented.

7. Practice (viva preparation)

Answer in your own words; brief model answers follow.

1. Name the two parts of a shirt collar and state what is placed inside them and why.
2. A subject's chest is measured at 97 cm and the size-M garment spec gives chest 107 cm. What is the difference called, and what two kinds does it contain?
3. Why is the tape for a girth held snug but never tight, and what error does a tight tape produce?

4. Which component joins the front and back of the shirt across the shoulders, and what is fitted beneath it on the back for movement?
5. From §4, a subject measures neck 41 cm, chest 102 cm. Which size column fits him, and what collar size will his finished shirt carry?
6. Why must both sets of repeated measurements agree within 0.5 cm before the values are accepted?
7. Name the components that are cut as pairs and state the symmetry risk if one of a pair is cut wrongly.

Answer key

1. The band (stand) and the fall. Interlining is placed inside to give body, stiffness and a crisp edge that survives washing.
2. Ease: wearing ease (room to move and breathe) plus design ease (the fullness of the intended silhouette).
3. A tight tape compresses soft tissue and under-reads the girth; the pattern drafted from it is too small and the garment will strain at that point.
4. The yoke; beneath it the back carries pleats (or darts) giving shoulder-blade ease.
5. Size L. His shirt collar will be about 42 (neck 41 + about 1 cm wearing room), matching the L column of the garment spec.
6. Because drafting multiplies a measurement error into every pattern piece; agreement within 0.5 cm shows the points were found and read consistently, so the chart can be trusted as drafting input.
7. Fronts, sleeves and cuffs are cut as pairs (left and right). A wrongly cut member breaks the mirror symmetry of the garment — the two sides will not match in shape, length or pattern.

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